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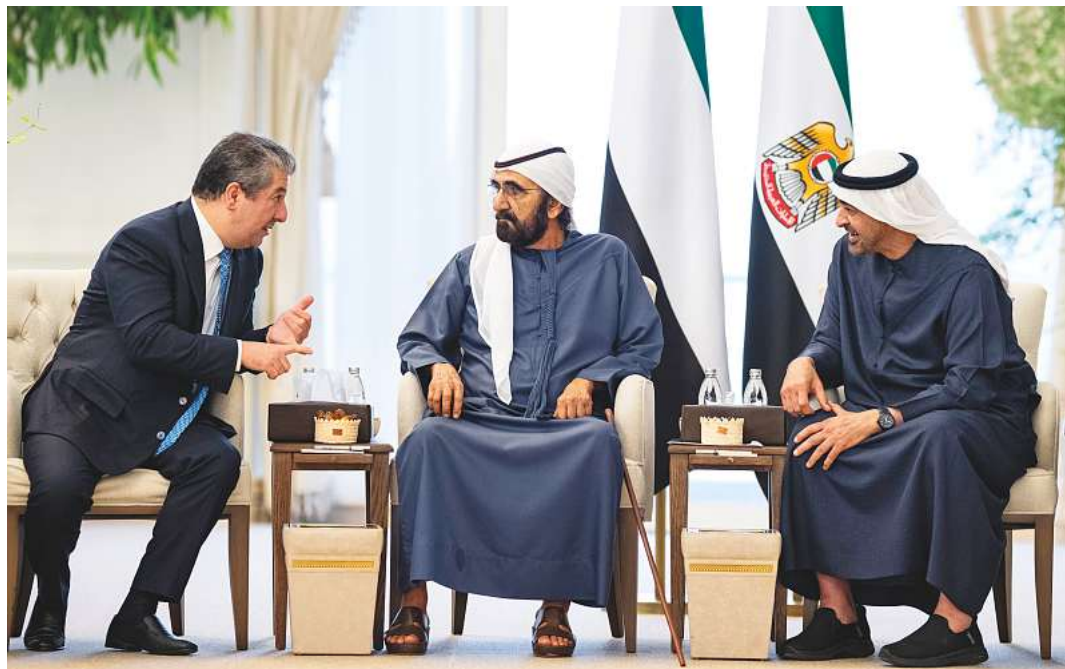
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UAE LEADERS MEET PRIME MINISTER OF KURDISTAN

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, along with His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, on Tuesday received Masrour Barzani, Prime Minister of the Kurdistan Region of Iraq. During the meeting, the two sides exchanged views on a number of issues of mutual interest and underscored the importance of efforts to strengthen security, stability and lasting peace in the Middle East for the benefit of all peoples of the region.

US, Iran trade attacks in new escalation as tensions rise

Kuwait, Bahrain, Jordan targeted; two Filipino sailors killed in tanker attack

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.

Senior Associate Editor

The US and Iran traded a new wave of attacks across the region yesterday, with Kuwait, Bahrain, Jordan and Iraq's Kurdistan region caught up in the six-month conflict's heaviest exchange in weeks.

Iran's Revolutionary Guards announced missile and drone attacks on US military sites across the region after extensive American strikes on Iran.

US President Donald Trump had warned Tehran of "much harder and higher" attacks if

it retaliated. The escalation has also proved deadly at sea.

Two Filipino sailors were killed aboard the Saudi-owned oil tanker Sidr in an attack while it was transiting the Strait of Hormuz late Monday. Saudi Arabia blamed Iran for targeting the vessel.

18 killed

Iranian military and state media, meanwhile, said the latest US bombardment killed 18 people. Among the casualties were four people, including a child, killed when a US strike hit a wedding in southern Iran.

The US Central Command said Tuesday's strikes focused on Iranian military targets including air defence sites, radar systems and maritime assets.

In Kuwait, authorities said an Iranian drone sparked a fire at a residential complex, while

air raid sirens sounded in Bahrain. Iran also said it targeted US military facilities in Jordan and Arbil.

Iran's Revolutionary Guards said two oil tankers caught fire after striking mines while attempting to transit the Hormuz outside a route designated by Tehran.

Washington also intensified its economic offensive, with Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent vowing to "sever every tie" Iran has with the outside world.

"My message to everyone is stay away," Bessent said. "We all want this conflict to end, and the fastest way for the conflict to end is for no one to provide any support to this regime. We are going to sever every tie that they have from the outside world."

— with inputs from AFP

SEE ALSO P6

MOHAMMED: UAE DOES NOT STOP AND WILL NOT STOP

Nation will not wait for ideal circumstances to deliver results

DUBAI

BY KHITAM AL AMIR

Chief News Editor

His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the

UAE and Ruler of Dubai, yesterday chaired the first Cabinet meeting of the new government season.

Marking the start of the new season, Sheikh Mohammed delivered three messages to government teams.

His first was that the UAE would not wait for ideal circumstances to continue delivering results.

"Our projects continue, our economy is growing, our markets are operating at full capacity and our events are welcoming the world," he said. "The UAE does not stop, and will not stop."

AI transformation

His second message focused on the government-wide AI transformation, describing it as a strategic, national and future-focused project capable of bringing about a fundamental shift in government operations. He urged all government teams to play a role in the transformation.

His third message centred on

trust, which he described as an asset the UAE had built over decades through the development of legislation, regulations and policies, major investment in world-class infrastructure, a strong international reputation and global relationships.

Cabinet AI Adviser System

The meeting, held at Qasr Al Watan in Abu Dhabi, approved the launch and use of the Cabinet AI Adviser System, which will deploy 32 specialised AI assistants to analyse policies, legislation, strategies and government systems.

The system will assess their potential impact, review international best practices and provide recommendations, while working with ministers around the clock to follow up on decisions and their implementation.

National Ecotourism Policy

The Cabinet also approved the National Ecotourism Policy and reviewed progress in implementing the National Strategy to Combat Desertification 2022-2030.

Sheikh Mohammed said the strategy had made impactful progress in protecting ecosystems and ensuring the sustainability of natural resources.

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Dh1.2 million Austrian shotgun steals the show

Hand-engraved firearm displayed at ADIHEX

ABU DHABI

BY ABDULLA RASHEED

Abu Dhabi Editor

A rare Austrian shotgun valued at around Dh1.2 million is drawing the attention of visitors at the Abu Dhabi International Hunting and Equestrian Exhibition (ADIHEX 2026), where it is being showcased by UAE-based Akila as one of the event's most distinctive luxury collectibles.

Taking around 18 months to complete, the bespoke shotgun combines precision craftsmanship with intricate hand engraving, elaborate detailing and 24-karat gold embellishments, transforming it from a hunting firearm into a highly refined collector's piece.

Khalid Al Kaabi, Execu-



tive Director of Akila, said the shotgun was among the most exceptional rare pieces the company had chosen to display at this year's exhibition.

"The manufacturing process took around a year and a half because of the precision and extensive hand craftsmanship involved," Al Kaabi said.

The shotgun is crafted from Grade 8 walnut wood, considered among the highest grades of walnut used in this type of firearm, and features intricate decorations finished with 24-karat gold.

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